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ICT Asian Range Trading Strategy — Asian Session Liquidity Sweep + Free PDF

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2026

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The ICT Asian range
trading strategy is
based on the liquidity



ICT PDF

sweep of the Asian range — the tight overnight consolidation that often traps retail traders before price reverses into the New York session.

The ICT Asian range lies between 07:00 PM and 12:00 AM New York local time. After the Asian range liquidity sweep, you can anticipate the next directional move of the day and align your trade with it.

This guide walks you through the Asian range — the session times, the bullish and bearish models, the entry options after the sweep, the stop and target placement, the common mistakes and the free PDF download.

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What is the ICT Asian Range?

The ICT Asian range is the range of the Asian session, which starts at 07:00 PM and ends at midnight 12:00 AM (New York local time).

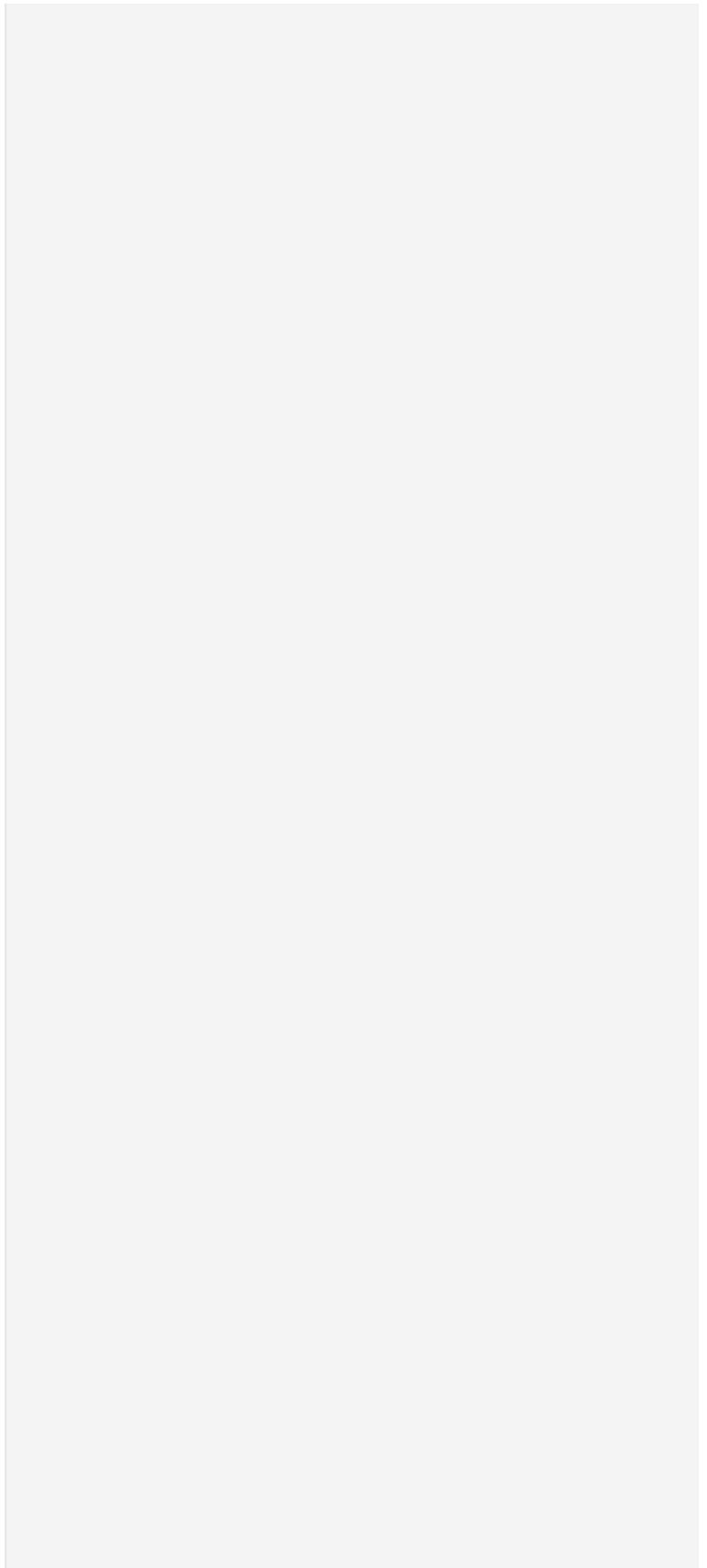
If you have a higher-timeframe directional bias you can use the

ICT Asian range to anticipate the likely movement of price after the Asian session.

A tight consolidation within the Asian range often signals an impending shift to a trending algorithm, which means the market is likely to sweep liquidity either above or below the Asian range.

This liquidity sweep traps retail traders in the wrong direction and price reverses afterwards.

You can see an example of the ICT Asian range in the picture below.





ICT Asian Range Time (NY Local, EST & GMT)

The Asian range is anchored to the New York local clock. Use the New York time as the base reference and let your charting platform translate to your local time zone.

- **New York local time (EST):** 07:00 PM to 12:00 AM
- **GMT:**
approximately
12:00 AM to 05:00 AM (during EST; shifts by one hour during EDT)
- **London time (BST):**
approximately
12:00 AM to 05:00 AM

The most important reference is the New York midnight open price, which marks the close of the Asian range and the boundary that price often returns to during the New York session.

How to Trade the Asian Range

To trade the ICT Asian

range strategy you need to have a directional bias. You then mark the high and low of the Asian range and wait for a liquidity sweep above the high or below the low.

For better understanding I cover the bullish and bearish setups separately below.

ICT Asian Range in a Bullish Market

First of all you should have a correct bullish bias of the market.

Mark the high and low of the Asian range and extend both lines forward.

In a bullish market you

look for price to drop below the low of the Asian range to sweep the liquidity and trap sellers.

Once the Asian-low has been taken, you may take any of the decisions below.

(I) You can take a buy trade below the New York midnight open price, but do not buy before the Asian range low has been taken.

(II) You may buy when price reverses and surpasses the high of the Asian range, as that confirms the bullish price direction.

(III) If you cannot buy below the midnight open or you have missed the opportunity,

then wait for price to return to the Asian range high in the New York open time.

You may wait for an **ICT Market Structure Shift** for confirmation of the trade.

In this scenario your stop loss will be 10 to 20 pips below the low of the Market Structure Shift.

For profit you may target the next **low resistance liquidity run**.

ICT Asian Range in a Bearish

Market

First of all, you should have a correct bearish bias of the market.

Mark the high and low of the Asian range and extend both lines forward.

In a bearish market you look for price to rise above the high of the Asian range to sweep the liquidity and trap buyers.

Once the Asian high has been taken, you may make any of the following decisions.

(I) You can take a sell trade above the New York midnight open price, but do not sell before the Asian range high has been taken.

(II) You may sell when price reverses and falls below the low of the Asian range, confirming the bearish price direction.

(III) If you cannot sell above the midnight open or you have missed the opportunity, then wait for price to return to the Asian range low during the New York open time.

In this scenario your stop loss will be 10 to 20 pips above the high of the Market Structure Shift.

For profit you may target the next low resistance liquidity run.

Step-by-Step Asian Range Trade Flow

This is the exact sequence I run before and during every Asian range trade.

- 1. Set the daily bias.**

Read the higher-timeframe bias on the daily and H4 — bullish, bearish or neutral.

- 2. Mark the Asian range.** 07:00 PM to 12:00 AM NY local time.

Highlight the high and low and extend both forward.

3. **Mark the New York midnight open.** The opening price at 12:00 AM NY local time becomes the reference for entry placement.

4. **Wait for the sweep.** Price must take out the Asian high (bearish setup) or the Asian low (bullish setup). The sweep almost always happens during the London open or the early NY-AM session.

5. **Drop to the lower timeframe.** 5-minute or 1-minute for the entry trigger.

6. **Wait for an MSS.** A Market Structure Shift confirms intent.

7. **Enter on the retracement.** Into the order block, fair value gap or mean threshold left behind by the displacement.
8. **Set the stop.** 10 to 20 pips beyond the MSS swing.
9. **Take profit at LRLR.** The first low-resistance liquidity pool in the trend direction.

Best Pairs and Markets for the Asian Range Strategy

The Asian range works on every market that the ICT methodology is applied to, but the cleanest setups print on a specific subset.

- **GBP/USD** and **EUR/USD** — the Asian range is tight on these pairs and the London open routinely sweeps it before delivering the directional move.
- **NQ (NASDAQ futures)** and **ES (S&P 500 futures)** — the overnight session forms a clean range that the New York open frequently sweeps.
- **XAU/USD (Gold)** — Asian range setups print especially well around the London-NY session overlap.

- **USD/JPY** and **AUD/USD** — Asian-session-active pairs that often build the range itself rather than just being swept by it.

For traders in the United States who follow the CFTC FIFO and no-hedge rules, the Asian range setup is most natural on NQ and ES futures (CME Group). The 09:50 NY-AM **macro window** often delivers the second leg of the move after the Asian range sweep, making the two strategies complementary on the same trading day.

What Confirmation to Look for After the

Asian Liquidity Sweep?

Once price has swept the liquidity of the Asian range you may look for an **ICT Market Structure Shift** for the confirmation of price reversal before executing your trade.

The MSS is the single most important filter for this strategy. A wick that takes out the Asian high or low without a clean MSS afterwards is not yet a tradeable reversal.

Does Price Sweep Asian Liquidity Every Day?

No, it is not necessary.

As traders we

anticipate prices rather than guarantee them. Therefore it is crucial to look for a liquidity sweep first — and only if it occurs do you plan the trade accordingly.

On a Sunday Asian session, on a holiday week, or when high-impact news lands inside the London open, the Asian range may either fail to form a tight range or be cleanly bypassed without the textbook sweep. On those days, sit out and wait for the next session.

Common Mistakes When Trading the Asian Range

These are the recurring mistakes I see when

traders first start trading the Asian range setup.

1. **Pre-positioning before the sweep.**

The sweep is the trigger. Entries placed before the Asian high or low is taken almost always end with a stopped trade.

2. **No higher-timeframe bias.**

The Asian range is a continuation pattern in the direction of the daily bias. Without a clear bias, every sweep looks like a setup, and most are not.

3. **Skipping the MSS.**

A wick alone is not the trade. A close-back-inside followed by a Market Structure Shift on the lower timeframe is the trigger.

4. **Stop too tight.**

Stops parked exactly at the MSS swing get hunted on the second test. The 10 to 20 pip buffer is non-negotiable.

5. **Trading every**

Asian range. Not every Sunday-to-Friday session produces a tradeable Asian range. If the range is too wide or the daily bias is unclear, sit out.

6. Wrong pair for the wrong session.

Trying to trade the Asian range on US-only instruments during the actual Asian session itself usually produces no tradeable setup. Wait for the London or NY-AM open before acting on the sweep.

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Trading Strategy
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FAQs about the ICT Asian Range

Brief answers to the questions readers ask most often about the Asian range.

What is the ICT Asian range?

The ICT Asian range is the range of the Asian session — the high and low formed between 07:00 PM and 12:00 AM New York local time.

The range is used as a future liquidity target during the London and New York sessions.

What is the Asian range time?

07:00 PM to 12:00 AM

New York local time.

The reference clock is

New York; ICT

recommends following

the NY local time

regardless of where you live.

Why do retail traders get trapped in the Asian range?

The Asian range is tight, so breakout traders take positions in the direction of the breakout. The institutional algorithm typically sweeps the breakout liquidity and then reverses, leaving the retail breakout entries trapped.

How do I confirm an

Asian range trade?

Wait for an ICT Market Structure Shift on the lower timeframe after the sweep. The MSS is the confirmation that price has rejected the swept level.

Where is the stop loss on an Asian range trade?

10 to 20 pips beyond the swing of the Market Structure Shift — below the MSS low for buy trades and above the MSS high for sell trades.

Where is the take profit on an Asian range trade?

The next low-resistance liquidity run (LRLR) in the direction of the

trade — typically the prior session high/low or the next external pool.

Does the Asian range work on indices and gold?

Yes — NQ, ES and XAU/USD form clean overnight ranges that the New York session frequently sweeps, making this strategy effective across forex, indices and metals.

What is the difference between the Asian range and the Asian session?

The Asian session is the broader trading window of Tokyo plus Sydney. The Asian range is the specific 07:00 PM to 12:00 AM NY local time

block ICT uses as a sweep reference.

Does daylight saving change the Asian range time?

The Asian range is anchored to New York local time, so the GMT and London-time references shift by an hour twice a year, but the NY local time stays constant.

Can beginners trade the Asian range?

Yes — the strategy is mechanical: mark the high and low, wait for the sweep, wait for the MSS, take the entry. The biggest hurdle for beginners is the daily bias, which improves with practice on a demo account.

24 Comments

Samuel

July 17, 2024 at
7:36 am

Should one wait
till London open
at 3am (NY
time) before
executing the
trade

Reply

Ayub Rana

July 18, 2024 at
1:07 am

Yes its better to
wait

Rep

Azam

July 19, 2024 at
4:09 pm

Hello

please mention
time frame in
your posts,
specially best
time frame for
any strategy you
are explaining.

Reply

Ayub Rana

July 20, 2024 at
7:52 am

All the times are
mention
according to
New York local
time

Rep

Ali Erron

July 21, 2024 at
8:46 am

I believe she
means which
TimeFrame, not
session.
like M5 M15 or
H1

Rep

Ayub Rana

July 21, 2024 at
2:49 pm

you are right i
just
misunderstood

Rep

Azam

July 21, 2024 at
3:26 pm

No dear I mean
time frame like
4H,1H,15m etc

Rep

Ayub Rana

July 22, 2024 at
3:17 pm

OH OKAY i will
mention it

Rep

A.Hussein

July 20, 2024 at
12:34 am

Hello Ayub,
thank for your

knowledge, I
learnt a lot from
you I appreciate
🙏 thank you so
much, having

said that in
kenya mostly we
use mobile
money transfer
like mpesa is
easy for us, like
me I don't have
card, I would like
to grap the E-
book, please
consider.

Reply

Ali Erron

July 21, 2024 at
8:44 am

Nice Job!
Very simple and
understandable
setup. Many
guru's explained
this setup but

none of them
make so clear
like you. Thank
you.

RTW which

...which
timeframe and
what symbols
(pairs or indices
or metals) we
can use this
setup?

Reply

Ayub Rana

July 21, 2024 at
2:50 pm

I mainly trade
XAUUSD using
m15 with higher
time-frame like
d1 and h4 bias

Rep

**Khalifa
Mohammed
Abdullahi**

August 15, 2024 at

10:39 pm

Does ICT Asian
range works
always for Gold

Rep

Ayub Rana

August 16, 2024
at 12:07 pm

It works if you
have a correct

Daily Bias

Rep

Elizabeth

July 26, 2024 at
11:27 am

Hello Ayub, I
have been
learning how to
trade since
January this
year. I have
never executed
even a single
trade. Do you

offer mentorship

and for how
much?

Reply

Ayub Rana

August 18, 2024
at 9:53 am

Yes you can
download eBook
at ictpdf.com

Rep

Sankhadeep

Nag

July 31, 2024 at
11:01 am

make a blog on
CRT

Reply

Ayub Rana

July 31, 2024 at
4:09 pm

ok

Rep

Carl Joseph

August 3, 2024 at
9:46 am

Good day. I've got a question to ask. Has the asian range changed now that the new York local time has become utc-5? I observed that the asian session starts at 08pm instead of the 7pm that you mentioned in this post. Your clarification will be highly appreciated

Reply

Sam

September 27,
2024 at 1:17 am

Salut moi c'est
Sam je voudrais
savoir si le win
rate de ce
stratégie et si je
peux l'utiliser
dans des
devises
majeurs, et
d'autres
matières
premières apart
l'or.

Reply

Ayub Rana

September 27,
2024 at 10:39 am

vous pouvez

vous pouvez
tester cette
stratégie, mais
d'après mon
expérience, elle
fonctionne bien
avec les
principales
devises et
métaux.

Rep

Lilac

October 4, 2024
at 12:09 am

Thanks for this
great
knowledge, pls
what time is the
New work mid
night open and
close

Reply

Ayub Rana

October 18, 2024
at 10:29 pm

NY-Midnight
open at 12:00
AM New-York
Local time

Rep

brytonmrtinz

December 13,
2024 at 4:06 am

Kindly attach
the times
frames
necessary to
observe sweep
of ASIAN
RANGE HIGH or

ASIAN RANGE
LOW and UOON
WHICH ENTRY
TIME FRAME.

Reply

Ayub Rana

December 13,
2024 at 8:56 am

15-minutes and
5-minutes
timeframes

Rep